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Why Your Offering Drops Every Holiday

The Attendance-Revenue Trap Every Church Faces

> 30% of your members missed last Sunday. So did 30% of your offering.

A free guide for church leaders by Algolog Limited | autogiving.ng

March 2026

THE ATTENDANCE-REVENUE TRAP

Every pastor knows the pattern. Holiday Sunday, rainy Sunday, long weekend — attendance drops, and so does the offering. It happens like clockwork: fewer people in the seats means less money in the basket.

The Math

If your church has **500 regular attendees** giving an average of **NGN 2,000 per Sunday**, a full Sunday brings in **NGN 1,000,000**.

When **30% of your congregation misses** a single Sunday, you lose **NGN 300,000** that week. Not because people stopped caring — but because they were not physically present.

And it is not just public holidays. Think about all the Sundays affected by:

- **Travel season** (December/January) — families travel, attendance thins out for weeks
- **Rainy season Sundays** — heavy downpours keep members at home
- **Public holidays** — Independence Day, Democracy Day, Eid periods
- **Traffic and heat** — a hot Saturday night keeping people home Sunday morning
- **Personal travel** — work trips, family visits, weddings out of town

Count the reduced Sundays honestly: most churches experience **at least 10–15 Sundays per year** where attendance drops by 20–40%.

What it's costing your church:

[Average Sunday offering] × [% attendance drop] × [Number of reduced Sundays per year]

For a church averaging NGN 1M per Sunday with 12 reduced Sundays at 30% drop:
That is NGN 3.6 million per year that simply does not arrive.

WHY "JUST TRANSFER IT" DOESN'T WORK

Most churches have tried the obvious solution: announce from the pulpit, "If you cannot attend next Sunday, please transfer your offering."

Why it consistently fails:

1. **People forget.** Life happens. The intention is real on Sunday morning, but by Monday it has faded. By Tuesday, it is forgotten entirely.

2. **No dedicated church account publicized.** Members do not have the bank details handy when the moment of giving comes. They would have to search for it, ask someone, or wait — and waiting usually means it never happens.

3. **No categorization.** A bank transfer is just a lump sum. The church cannot tell tithes from offerings from building fund contributions. Your finance team has to guess or follow up manually.

4. **No receipt.** Members have no record of their giving for personal accountability, tax purposes, or simply the peace of mind that their contribution was received and recorded.

5. **No follow-up mechanism.** The church has no way to know who intended to give but did not. There is no system to gently remind or track consistency.

The underlying issue:

You are asking people to do something manually, repeatedly, with no system to support them. That is a **system design problem**, not a faithfulness problem.

It is not that your members do not want to give. It is that there is no system making it easy for them to give consistently.

THE 3 TYPES OF CHURCH INCOME

Understanding your income mix is the first step to financial stability.

Type 1: Spontaneous Giving

One-time offerings, visitor gifts, special appeals. This income is **unpredictable by nature** — it depends entirely on who is present and how they feel in the moment.

Type 2: Seasonal Giving

Harvest thanksgiving, Christmas, Easter, special projects. The timing is predictable, but the amounts **vary widely** year to year.

Type 3: Committed Recurring Giving

The backbone of financially healthy churches. Same amount, same frequency, **rain or shine, travel or not**. This is the income you can plan around — the income that lets you budget for staff salaries, building maintenance, outreach programmes, and growth.

The healthiest churches worldwide have **50–70% of their income from Type 3**. Most Nigerian churches are **80% or more dependent on Type 1** — entirely reliant on who physically shows up on Sunday.

The goal is not to eliminate spontaneous giving. It is to build a **predictable floor of recurring income** so your church can plan, budget, and grow with confidence.

THE FREE FIX — DO THIS TODAY

You do not need to buy any software to start solving this problem. Here are five steps you can implement this week:

1. **Open a Dedicated Offering Account**
   If you do not already have one, open a separate church offering account (distinct from your operations account). This makes giving by transfer clean and trackable.

2. **Print the Account Details on a Card**
   Create a simple card with your bank name, account number, and church name. Hand one to every member. Make it wallet-sized so they keep it with them.

3. **Announce It Every Sunday**
   Every single Sunday, verbally remind the congregation: "If you are travelling next week or cannot attend for any reason, you can still give — here are the bank details." Repetition is key. Say it until people can recite it.

4. **Have Personal Conversations with Key Givers**
   For your most committed givers (your top 20–30 members), have a personal conversation: "Would you be willing to set up a standing order with your bank for your monthly tithe?" Standing orders are free at most Nigerian banks.

5. **Create a Simple Tracking Sheet**
   Set up a basic spreadsheet: Member Name | Pledged Amount | Frequency | Jan | Feb | Mar | and so on. Track who is consistent and who might need a gentle follow-up.

An honest note:

This approach works — but it depends on members remembering, banks processing standing orders reliably (they often do not), and manual tracking by your finance team. It is a good start, but it **breaks down at scale**.

THE AUTOMATED FIX

What Effortless Giving Looks Like

Here is what giving looks like when there is a proper system behind it:

1. **Your church gets a branded giving link:** autogiving.ng/yourchurch
2. **A member visits the link on their phone** — no app to download, no registration hassle, just a clean page with your church name, logo, and colours.
3. **They choose a category** — Tithes, Offerings, Building Fund, Missions, or whatever categories you have set up.
4. **They set an amount and frequency** — weekly or monthly, whatever they choose.
5. **First payment goes through** — their card is securely saved (tokenized, not stored as raw card data).
6. **From then on, giving happens automatically.** Every week or every month. Whether they attend or not. Whether it rains or not. Whether they are in Abuja or Lagos or London.
7. **Members can pause, adjust, or cancel anytime** — no lock-in, no pressure, no awkward conversations.
8. **Church admin sees everything on a dashboard** — who gave, how much, which category, when. Export to CSV anytime.
9. **Receipts sent automatically** to every giver (email and SMS) after each transaction.
10. **Funds go directly to your church bank account** — never touches anyone else's account.

This is Pledged.

Your members set it up once. Giving continues **rain or shine, holiday or not**.

IS YOUR CHURCH IN THE ATTENDANCE-REVENUE TRAP?

Answer honestly — yes or no:

#	Statement	Yes / No
1	Our offering noticeably drops on holiday weekends or rainy Sundays	
2	We have asked members to transfer when they cannot attend, but few actually do	
3	We do not know what percentage of our income comes from recurring vs one-time giving	
4	We cannot accurately predict next month's total income	
5	Our church budget is based on hope rather than committed pledges	

Your Score:

0-1 Yes — Your church is in good shape. You likely already have systems supporting consistent giving.

2-3 Yes — There are gaps in your giving infrastructure. Addressing them now will make a meaningful difference.

4-5 Yes — Your church is heavily exposed to the attendance-revenue trap. Every missed Sunday is costing you significantly.

FREE 15-MINUTE CHURCH GIVING AUDIT

We only do 10 per month.

In 15 minutes, we will look at your current giving patterns, identify the biggest gaps, and show you exactly what a recurring giving system could look like for your church — branded with your name, logo, and colours.

Reach out to:

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No obligation. No pressure. Just a conversation about what is possible for your church.

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